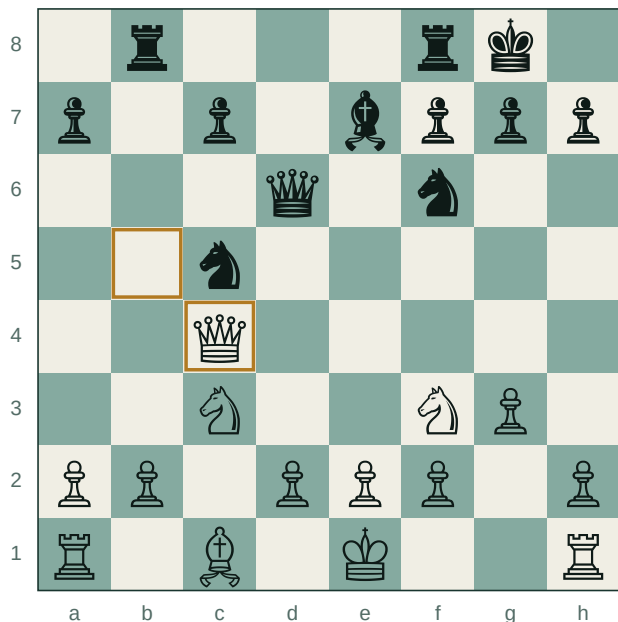


Discovered attacks: Black, move 13

Discovered attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 13.Qc4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

13...Rb4 14. Qxb4 Nd3+ 15. exd3 Qxb4

13...Rb4 The rook moves from b8 to b4. Recorded reply: **14.Qxb4**.

14...Nd3+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From d3 it attacks king on e1, queen on b4 and bishop on c1. Recorded reply: **15.exd3**.

15...Qxb4 The queen captures the queen on b4.

At the end, nominal material is White 26 / Black 25 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from -2 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Choose the blocker's destination carefully. An uncovered attack may fail if the opponent has a stronger check or can capture the slider.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Moving a blocker can uncover a rook, bishop, or queen attack. The moving piece may create a second threat, giving the defender too many problems at once.

HOW TO LOOK

Find a friendly piece between a slider and an enemy target, then inspect its forcing moves and captures.

The defending king is on e1. Geometrically undefended: queen on c4 and rook on h1. Check for tactical protection.